

FREE FOR TRADIES

THE TRADIE FOLLOW-UP KIT

A 15-minute enquiry check and 10 messages you can copy today.



INSIDE

1. **The 15-minute enquiry leak check.** Find where work slips away.
2. **10 messages to copy.** Missed calls, quotes, bookings, invoices and reviews.
3. **The rules, in plain English.** Job messages, marketing and reviews.
4. **Want these to send themselves?**

START HERE

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

Most tradies don't lose jobs because of their work. They lose them in the gaps: a call missed on a roof, a quote nobody followed up, an invoice that slid past due. This kit helps you find those gaps and gives you the words to close them.

1. **Do the check in Part 1.** It takes about 15 minutes. You'll end up with a short list of the gaps in your week.
2. **Copy the messages you need from Part 2.** Swap the **[brackets]** for your details, and change any wording so it sounds like you.
3. **Save them where you'll actually use them:** your phone's text shortcuts or quick replies, your email templates, or the message templates in your job software.
4. **Read Part 3 once.** It covers the few rules that apply to messages like these, in plain English.

One gap fixed properly beats ten half-fixed. Start with the biggest one, and come back to the rest next week.

PART 1

THE 15-MINUTE ENQUIRY LEAK CHECK

Fill in the table, answer five questions, then count your “nobody” answers. Each one is a gap where work can slip away.

Step 1: Where do enquiries arrive? (5 minutes)

For each place, write who replies and how quickly that usually happens. Cross out any you don't use.

Where enquiries arrive	Who replies?	How fast, usually?	What happens if nobody's free?
Phone calls			
Voicemail			
Text messages			
Email			
Website form			
Facebook and Instagram messages			
Google Business Profile (calls, messages)			
Lead or job platforms			
Other:			

Step 2: Five questions (5 minutes)

1. **When you miss a call on a job, what does the caller hear or see?** Voicemail only? A text? Nothing?
2. **Where is the list of quotes waiting on an answer?** In your head counts as “nowhere”.
3. **Who follows up a quote, and when?**
4. **After a job, what happens, and in what order?** Invoice, thank-you, review request?
5. **How do you know when an invoice is overdue?**

Step 3: Count your gaps (5 minutes)

- ☐ Count every answer that was “nobody”, “no system” or “it depends”.
- ☐ Circle the one that costs you the most work or the most money.
- ☐ Fix that one first, using the matching message in Part 2.

PART 2

TEN MESSAGES TO COPY

Each message says when to send it and when to stop. Replace the [brackets], keep it short, and always say who you are.

1 Missed-call text

When: Within a few minutes of missing a call while you're working.

Hi, it's [your name] from [business]. Sorry I missed your call, I'm on a job. I'll call you back by [time]. If it's easier, text me what you need and your suburb.

Stop: Once you've spoken to them.

Tip: Save it as a text shortcut so it takes two taps between jobs.

2 Enquiry received

When: As soon as you see a website or email enquiry.

Hi [first name], thanks for getting in touch with [business] about [job]. I've got your message and I'll get back to you by [day or time] to talk it through. If it's urgent, call me on [number]. – [your name]

Stop: Send once.

3 Photos and details, please

When: Before quoting a job you haven't seen.

Hi [first name], [your name] from [business] here. To give you an accurate price, could you send a few photos of [the area or job] and your suburb? A rough idea of when you'd like it done helps too. Thanks!

Stop: Once you have what you need to quote.

4 Quote sent

When: Straight after you send the quote.

Hi **[first name]**, I've just emailed your quote for **[job]**. It's valid until **[date]**. Happy to answer any questions, just reply or call me on **[number]**. – **[your name]**, **[business]**

Stop: Send once.

5 Quote follow-up

When: 2–3 business days after sending the quote, if you haven't heard back.

Hi **[first name]**, **[your name]** from **[business]**. Just checking you got the quote for **[job]** and whether you have any questions. If the timing or scope needs changing, let me know and I'll adjust it. Reply STOP if you'd rather I didn't follow up.

Stop: As soon as they reply, accept, decline or say stop.

6 Final quote follow-up

When: About a week after message 5, if there's still no reply.

Hi **[first name]**, one last check on the **[job]** quote. It's valid until **[date]**, and I can fit you in **[timeframe]** if you'd like to go ahead. No worries if you've gone another way, I won't chase again. – **[your name]**

Stop: This is the last one. Then keep your word.

7 Booking confirmation and reminder

When: Confirmation as soon as the job is booked; reminder the day before.

CONFIRMATION

Hi [first name], you're booked in with [business] for [job] on [day, date] between [time window] at [address]. Reply to this message if anything changes. – [your name]

REMINDER

Hi [first name], a reminder that [your name] from [business] is booked for tomorrow, [day], between [time window]. Please make sure we can get to [area]. Reply if you need to reschedule.

Stop: If the job is cancelled or moved, send the new details instead.

8 On my way

When: As you head to the job.

Hi [first name], [your name] from [business] here. I'm on my way and should be there around [time]. See you soon.

Stop: Send once.

9 Overdue invoice reminders

When: The day after the due date, then again about a week later if it's still unpaid.

FIRST REMINDER

Hi **[first name]**, a friendly reminder that invoice **[number]** for **[job]** (\$ **[amount]**) was due on **[date]**. If you've already paid, thanks, and please ignore this. The payment details are on the invoice, or reply and I'll send another copy. – **[your name]**, **[business]**

SECOND REMINDER

Hi **[first name]**, invoice **[number]** for \$ **[amount]** is now **[number of days]** days overdue. Could you let me know when I can expect payment? If something's not right with the work or the invoice, tell me and we'll sort it out. – **[your name]**

Stop: As soon as it's paid, or they raise a problem. Then deal with the problem first.

Tip: Keep reminders polite and factual. Don't add fees or charges your quote or terms didn't include.

10 Review request

When: Within a day or two of finishing a job, to every customer.

Hi **[first name]**, thanks for choosing **[business]** for **[job]**. If you have a minute, an honest Google review really helps a small business like mine: **[review link]**. Thanks either way! – **[your name]**. Reply STOP to opt out.

Stop: Send once. Don't chase reviews.

Tip: Ask everyone, not only the customers you think are happy, and never offer anything in return for a review (Part 3).

PART 3

KEEPING MESSAGES FRIENDLY AND WITHIN THE RULES

Messages about a job the customer asked about are fine. Promotions need permission and an easy way out. Reviews must be honest.

This is general information, not legal advice. If you're unsure about your situation, ask a professional.

- **Say who you are.** Put your name and business name in every message, and make sure your contact details are right.
- **Job messages and marketing are different.** Confirmations, reminders, quotes the customer asked for and invoices are about their job. Specials, newsletters and “we're running a deal” messages are marketing.
- **Marketing needs permission and an opt-out.** Under the Spam Act, you need the person's consent to send marketing texts and emails, every message must say who it's from, and it must include an easy way to opt out, such as “Reply STOP”. Opt-outs must be actioned within five working days. See the ACMA's guide: [Avoid sending spam](#).
- **Keep job messages free of sales pitches.** Adding a promotion to a booking reminder can turn it into a marketing message.
- **Stop when they reply.** Follow-ups end the moment the customer answers, says no, or asks you to stop.
- **Reviews must be honest.** Ask every customer, not only the happy ones. Never write, buy or arrange fake reviews, and don't offer rewards only for positive reviews. Google doesn't allow rewards for reviews at all. See the ACCC's guide: [Online reviews for products and services](#).
- **Be considerate about timing.** Avoid texting late at night or very early in the morning.

PART 4

WANT THESE TO SEND THEMSELVES?

Copying messages works. Having them send automatically, from the software you already use, works better. That's what Pilot Systems sets up.

	What it does	Founding price
Software Tune-up	Sets up to 3 automatic features in job or accounting software you already pay for: quote follow-ups that stop when the customer replies or accepts, booking confirmations and reminders, overdue invoice reminders, and review requests after every job	from \$690
Single feature	One of the above	from \$390
Lead Capture Pack	Missed-call text-back (where your phone plan supports it), an instant reply to website enquiries, an alert for every new enquiry, and every enquiry in one place	from \$1,490

Fixed written price before you commit. No GST added. Founding rates apply to our first 5 projects.

NOT SURE WHICH GAP TO FIX FIRST?

Book a free 15–25 minute discovery call at pilotsystems.com.au/contact or call **0457 471 392**. No obligation.

This kit is general information to help you run your business. It isn't legal, financial or other professional advice, and it doesn't guarantee more jobs or payments. Check that each message suits your business and your customers before you use it. You're welcome to copy, change and use these messages in your own business.

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